



Zoom in

The last smartphone featuring an optical zoom was the Samsung Galaxy K. Asus picked up where K left off with its latest entrant – the Zoomfone. With a bulky design, the Galaxy K wasn't very good. Asus has upped the ante and given us the slimmest phone with an optical zoom. Measuring at 11.95 mm at its thickest point, it also gives you OIS, laser guided AF, full manual controls and 3X optical zoom.

4K for 499.99

Sony has jumped on the action cam bandwagon and is taking things seriously. The 4K Action Cam records 4K video at up to 30 fps and gives you images that are roughly 9 megapixels in resolution. It can spit these images out at the rate of 60 per minute. All the gadgetry is housed within a splashproof body and is further protected by Sony's SPK-X1 waterproof case. For your money, you also get image stabilisation, a 170-degree wide-angle lens with an aperture of F2.8 and a standard tripod mount. With a price tag of \$499.99 (₹30,776), there's not much that sets it apart from the GoPro Hero4 Black.



Outfox thieves with MyFox

Let's face it, having your home broken into is no fun. MyFox's security system has all the bells and whistles found on the average security system with a few twists. One of them is the controllable shutter, which can be opened or closed. The camera can be moved around and paired with a separate security kit. It includes vibration sensors, alarms and a little intelligence as it comes with its own power backup, and if your Wi-Fi goes down, it can piggyback off a nearby system. Sadly, this object of desire will be available only in the US and set you back by \$500 (₹30,754) for the whole kit.



Knockout Nikon

Nikon featured two new products at CES. With the first, it decided to take the same path as Microsoft and skipped an entire model. The product we're talking about here is the D5500 (which replaces the D5300) – the one with the tilty-flippy screen. Nikon has ditched the plastic and adopted carbon-fiber reinforced plastic with this one as well, making it one of the lightest DSLRs around. It's also touted as the thinnest. If you're wondering what else is new, the list runs out immediately after the touchscreen and also, you lose GPS. Just like the last model, this has a 39-point AF, a 24.2MP APS-C sensor and an Expeed 4 image processor. It costs \$1,000 (₹61,550) with the standard 18-55 kit lens. If you already own a Nikon D5300, it really doesn't make sense to upgrade to this one. However, if you want to pick it up, you can get it for ₹59,950 if you want the 18-55 VR II, and ₹54,450 for just the body.



The more exciting offering from Nikon's stables is its new 300mm F4. Officially called the AF-S Nikkor 300mm f/4 PF ED VR Lens, the only unfamiliar abbreviation to the Nikon fanboy here will be the PF which stands for Phase Fresnel. A fresnel lens has concentric circles. This lens corrects nearly all chromatic aberrations on its own, thus allowing the lens makers to bring the length of the lens down by 75 mm. It's got a nine-blade aperture, like most pro Nikon lenses and a Nano Crystal Coat on the glass to prevent ghosting and lens flare. The lens also comes with VR II, giving shooters 4.5 stops of blur-free handheld shooting. It works on both, full frame and crop sensor DSLRs and accepts most teleconverters for a range extension. It's available for pre-order in the US for \$1,996 (₹1,22,725) at Adorama and BHP. Nikon says it'll be available here in February 2015 and prices will be announced then.